

Couples: Repair Script (Handout)

A short script to de-escalate and repair

Time-out: 'I'm getting flooded. I need 20 minutes to calm down. I will come back at ____.'

Return: 'Thanks for waiting. I want to understand. Here's what I heard you say...'

Validate: 'That makes sense because...' then make a specific request.

If there is fear/intimidation, prioritize safety and seek specialized help.